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BLASPHEMY OPEN THREAT TO DEMOCRACY

AGARIYAS - The marginalized salt farmers seasoning our meals

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Shortcut to Stardom

Gone are the days when silver screen celebrities and public figures hogged the limelight. Times have changed. Now anyone with a natural and exceptional talent or an expert professional skill set in any field or simply a gift of the gab can become a famous personality and also earn millions with the power of Vlogging. A Vlog is infact a combination of two words wherein 'V' stands for Video and 'log' is a written or a recorded account of an event, activity or any information. But the definition of any information does not include information motivated from malicious intentions, criminally or illegally motivated, unauthorized or publicly objectionable content as it will be immediately blocked and removed by the IT regulatory authorities or further worse it can even lead the Vlogger to unimaginable trouble.



Vlogging is infact a simple activity where the first step is to create one's own exclusive channel on YouTube, the world's second most frequented video portal after the search engine - Google. The second step is to make your own videos, edit them to make them interesting and entertaining and finally upload them online on your exclusive YouTube channel. The entire process is quite simple except for the later part - getting views for your videos and subscribers for your channel. More people watching your videos and subscribing to your YouTube channel will translate to more mullah for you from YouTube as well as your sponsors and advertisers. Plus, a massive surge in subscriptions will earn you fame and everything else besides money of course.

Vlogs are gradually gaining more popularity amongst all age groups than Television, Cinema and OTT platforms. The reason could be as simple as the people who are behind creating them. These Vlogs are created by ordinary people from the masses who share their interests, hobbies, skills, information, experiences and even their day-to-day lives. Therefore these Vlogs serve as a motivation and inspiration for common people who are easily able to relate to them.

YouTube is inundated with videos on different topics ranging from entertainment to recreation, motivation, information, education and much more. It certainly takes extraordinary talent and skill to draw the attention of millions of people and keep them engaged. Four years ago Rohit (name changed) was an Assistant Vice President in one of the leading private banks of India. Though his heart was always into Vlogging. Whatever spare time he had and whenever he travelled he recorded videos of the entire experience to upload on his YouTube channel giving his subscribers and viewers a truly real life experience of the entire excursion . Within a period of four years he managed to bag over five million subscribers with the help of some of his extremely adventurous and thrilling travel vlogs. That was the point when he decided to take the plunge after discussing it with his wife. He finally quit his job and went on to pursue his passion of becoming a full-time YouTube Vlogger. Like Rohit a lot of youngsters right from working professionals to even school going boppy teenagers are considering YouTube Vlogging as a serious career option and also their shortcut to stardom.

By Dheeraj Kale

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AGARIYAS

The marginalized salt farmers seasoning our meals

By Sajeeda Feroz

India is the third largest producer of salt, after China and the USA and a vast majority of the salt produced comes from a seasonal salt marsh called the Little Rann of Kutch, located in the Thar desert in Gujarat. Home to the tribal folk, Agariyas, since centuries, the Rann lies 130 km, west of Ahmedabad and was declared a sanctuary for the endemic, equine species, the Indian Wild Ass in 1973.





You could make any gourmet savoury dish using the most expensive ingredients, but without salt, it is rendered bland and flavourless. Salt could be considered the most important commodity in every household, but unfortunately for the farmers that harvest it; they are in dire need of attention, at least for what their salt is worth.

India is the third largest producer of salt, after China and the USA and a vast majority of the salt produced comes from a seasonal salt marsh called the Little Rann of Kutch, located in the Thar desert in Gujarat. Home to the tribal folk, Agariyas, since centuries, the Rann lies 130 km, west of Ahmedabad and was declared a sanctuary for the endemic, equine species, the Indian Wild Ass in 1973.

The Rann of Kutch spans a vast area of 5000 square kilometersover five zones – Kharaghoda, Jinjavada, Santalpur, Nimaknagar, and Halvad-Tikkar and consists of major underwater deposits called brine which is 10 times more saline than seawater. Hence, it contributes to 75% of the country's inland salt production. (Harchandani, 2020)

The rann turns into a brackish water lake during the southwest monsoon which lasts for a period of four months from June to September. It is during this time that the water from the 11 rivers in Saurashtra, North Gujarat, and Rajasthan, together with the tidal waves from the mighty Arabian Sea empty into the kutch through the Surajbaricreek.

The monsoon water dries towards the end of October. According to the Agariyas, this is the perfect time for them to migrate to the Rann, with survival essentials and set up their makeshift homes for the next eight months that ensue until the last of the salt is painstakingly harvested, just a little before the beginning of the monsoon cycle.Their makeshift huts, called "jhupdis" are made with jute bags, plastic sheets, and bamboo branches.

The tribes then dig up bore wells which take about one week and attach motors to extract the brine to the surface. This is followed by the creation of huge salt pans, using wet mud to form partitions in the soil.The farmers level the earth with the help of rollers to ensure that the brine doesn't seep back into the soil.

Each family prepares about 4 – 5 pans and each one of them has the potential to harvest 400 to 500 tonnes of salt each year. The salt pansare about 150 feet wide and 500 feet long. Smaller pans are built for the concentration of brine whereas the larger ones are used for the crystallization of salt. Everyone in the family helps. Children start working from the tender age of ten owing to generational poverty and lack of education.

The whole operation is done by hand except for the pump that brings the brine to the surface. The pumped-out brine is then let into the salt pans and left undisturbed to crystallize naturally, thus leaving behind precious crystals of white salt. A few dry branches are thrown in, around which salt crystals form. Nevertheless, the brine contains 4% salt concentration which is then passed between the pans seven times to bring the concentration to 28%.

The first layer of the salt formed is scraped with heavy wooden rakes. Once there are more layers, it requires two or three people to scrape it due to its heaviness. The farmers continue the process to break up the salt into smaller crystals as this fetches a higher price. Every fortnight, an average of 12-15 tonnes of salt is collected and sent to salt traders, companies and factories across the nation.

Once the salt is harvested, the families haul their equipment back to their villages. The monsoons arrive andthe salt fields vanish without a trace, turning the desert into a sea. Four months later, the Agariyas come back again and start from scratch.

The living environment of the Agariyas is so dilapidated so much so that something as basic as water, medication and sanitation is still a dream to the workers in the salt pans, who toil and moil each day, in hazardous and pathetic conditions putting their own lives in peril and turmoil, just for that, "Ek chutkinamak".

The tribal folk work every day in the sweltering heat, from October to June, for a marginal source of income. The sun cooks up their skin during the day and the land they walk upon blisters their feet during the evening. The temperature drops below 0 during winters and the summers are unbearabletouching up to 50 ℃ on the scale.

The farmers' legs become so stiff and thin being exposed to the salty brine their entire lives, that when they pass away, the bones don't burn in the funeral pyre and need to be buried separately with salt, to decompose naturally.

They face medical problems such as increased salt content in the body leading to vitamin and mineral deficiencies, ophthalmic problems such as vision loss and night blindness due to long hours of exposure to the blinding white topography which reflects in their eyes directly, musculoskeletal disorders, chronic dermatitis, asthma, traumatic ulcers, goitre, to name a few. They lack personal hygiene and access to basic



amenities such as drinking water, toilets, medicines, and waste management systems, thereby putting their health at risk.

Almost all agariyas are illiterate and do not have the knowledge of the occupational hazards they undergo in their line of work. Having a bath is considered a luxury, as the workers need to get to the nearest village which is at least 8 km away, and most often than not, they have to go on foot. They cannot afford the leisure of transport and sometimes do not have a shower for 15 days straight.

According to Business Insider, the agariyas earn anywhere between 300 Rs – 320 Rs per tonne, despite the back-breaking work they do in the desert, whereas the market rate is at a whopping (17000 Rs) per tonne.The production costs of the salt are so huge that the agariyas borrow money from local traders on loan to cover the costs entailing the fuel required to run motors,damages to be covered, new equipment to be bought, transportation of drinking water., etc.

Sometimes the farmers are exploited by the local traders owing to their loans and the prices are fixed by the traders, thereby leaving no room for the salt workers to bear the fruit of their work.

Ina good year they may make Rs. 8000 to Rs. 12000 per monthfor their gruelling work. After repaying loans, they are left with very less and sometimes go back home with negative savings. Their lesser priced product has hindered their socio-economic growth on a large scale and almost all of them live below the poverty line.The loans they acquire from traders has kept them in a cycle of debt forever and they have thus been locked inside the salt trade. With the current fuel rates, it has become near impossible to make a profit.

It is due to this fact that many families have abandoned salt farming and have taken up agriculture in nearby areas instead. Earlier there used to be numerous families practicing salt farming, in the hamlets neighbouring the Kutch, but now very few families remain.

Notwithstanding this, the agariyas are often left without work during the monsoon months, when the creek gets submerged and survive with the money earned from the harvest.

The agariyas have received help from the state government in the form of gum boots, subsidies, and solar panels to run the motors but there is a long way to go. A few NGOs like SEWA (Self Employed Womens Association), have partnered with reputed banks to contribute towards the education of the agariya children and lend a helping hand to uplift the living conditions of the women.

With a handful of savings, thanks to solar energy, the salt makers are gradually inching closer to a better future, with sustainable livelihoods and a better economic status. The solar powered motors during the day, along with the use of diesel-powered motors during the night have cut the fuel costs by more than half, for the agariyas. who are thereby seeing minor growth in their profits.

Thanks to the efforts of the Government of Gujarat. AgariyaHeetRakshak Manch along with Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan and Janpath, 31 abandoned Gujarat State Road Transport Corporation (GSRTC) buses were converted into high-tech RannShalas in Rannto impart education to 751 students in November 2019.

The buses serve as exclusiveexamples aimed at recycling and utilize the innovative use of solar panels and LED lights. Each bus is equipped with 16 fans, six LED lights, one green board, one television and six soft boards and accommodated 18 – 24 students. With a water container of 20 litres and a water tank of 700 litres, this eco-friendly school infrastructure is helping students to learn and live a better life. (Parekh, 2019).

Although the efforts have been implemented to considerable extent, humongous help is needed in the Kutch due to its vast expanse and most often than not it becomes tediously difficult to reach each and every person in the desert.

The Agariyas are a hardworking bunch and do not want to leave the tradition of salt making which is ther sole livelihood, that has existed for generations. They love their freedom and their simple life, but only want better living conditions from the higher authorities, such as health, better socio-economic status and education for their children. Despite being a striking example of a marginalized community dwelling in torrid conditions, they look forward to that one ray of hope that might one day change their lives for the better.

Since they own no farm land and possess no other skills, the agariyas and social activists demand the traditional user rights for salt farming and access to basic facilities during the harvest season. There is an immense need for programs and initiatives spearheaded by the government and civil society organisations to pledge incessant co – operation and support in helping set up decent lifestyles for the Agariya tribe. The government could also set a common selling price which would benefit the farmers immensely and save them from exploitation.

A huge chunk of monetary resources is spent on making life easy, but for people who already have it great. Therefore, such resources should be made use of to find solutions to make ease the suffering of those who really need it.

If modern technology is exercised the right way, so many lives would be saved. The people living below the poverty lines and those living in remote areas are the ones who are unfortunately treated as outcasts in the current world of modern technology. There is so much we can do for people from all walks of life, if only we knew where to look and chased after the ones who needed it.



Blasphemy: open threat to Democracy

Prasad Shivaji Joshi

Almost every citizen of the world influenced by Religion. Some of them practices the religious tradition for inner satisfaction and converting self-centered consciousness in to universal brotherhood. So the religion makes you true Human. But there is a huge cons of religion is law of Blasphemy.

Blasphemy

In some religions there is only one messenger, only one Book and the following the guidelines of this book is the only way to become a religious person. Hence there is no chance for the curious questions. Every person should have respect the messenger, no matter the person is following or not the religion. If someone, by anyway Condemn the messenger then this is called as Blasphemy. And there is a provision of severe punishment for the act of blasphemy. Like Death penalty of life imprisonment. This is the open threat to Democracy.

In a recent incidents in Udaipur, Amrawati (India) Innocent peoples brutally murdered in the name of Blasphemy.

Democracy

In fact, the foundation on which a nation, society, or an individual stands is one of morality. This is an ideal code of conduct which explains how a person should behave in public and private life. The formation of ethical values is essential for the overall development of the nation and society.

Democracy is one of the ideal system in the world where every citizen in the system has an opportunity for their Social and economic growth. It has been survived on the values of freedom, equality and justice. Every citizen has the freedom to express his or her views through speech and writing. Every citizen is equal before the law. There will be no inequality on the basis of caste, religion, language, gender and region. He has strong right to seek justice, if injustice is done to him. Despite all these ideals, why are there so many questions in the society?

Political Agenda

The political agenda is the root cause of the development and also the perdition of the nation. To make a powerful politician, they feels like greedy for the political gain in every section of the life. They even change the meaning of democratic values for their convenience. Like Secularism.

Secularism

Secularism means, respect the all religions while following our own religion. But now-a-days Secularism is a powerful political tool for the political profits. Divisive political parties and politician continuously make fear in minds of minority groups about majority religion. Therefore they feels unsecure and make strong vote bank and the divisive agenda of political parties favor the politically powerful minority religious groups. To appease such groups they started to disrespect politically weak groups and their religion. They even misuse of the freedom of expression.

As a result, the basic meaning of democratic values is sidelined and democracy is undermined by all organs.

Religion and Nation

India is a constitutionally secular nation. But the DNA of this country is spiritual and religious. Foreign invaders have ruled for thousands of years but the people here are still spiritual and religious. That is why the Constitution has given religious freedom to every citizen. But this does not mean that religion is greater than national interest. Every person is first a citizen of the country and then of his religion. Religion is a very personal matter. There is a way to removing all the bugs in personality. Like Jealousy, Anger, Greediness etc. In fact, tolerance is one of the basic characteristics of this soil. Different religions have freedom to spread their religion by increasing the followers.

The principles of any religion should not be greater than national interest. Every religion in the country should be favorable to the national interest. They should accept the constitution of the country. It is bad practice for the democracy when any religion follow the personal law of his religion.

If any religious behavior creates a question of law and order or if it interferes with the national interest, then such freedom of religion is not applicable. In fact every religious authorities should create conducive environment to national unity. Many temples had set up isolation centers in their halls during national disasters like the Covid-19. Lunch boxes were provided at several places.



Threat to Democracy

Punishment of the blasphemer creates many questions. Parallel Personal Law Board of any religion is completely unconstitutional existence. India is a constitutionally secular nation so there is no law like blasphemy. Hinduism is the religion of Majority in India. But there is no such thing as a personal law board in Hinduism and the number of those who act in such a manner is negligible.

Probably this is the reason why heterogeneous writing about the God and goddess in Hinduism in the country is widely done through plays, films and songs. M. F. Hussain can fill his exhibitions by drawing nude pictures of Hindu deities. From his lectures, one can easily make derogatory statements about Hindu Dharma tradition. The poster for the black documentary was released recently. It shows Goddess Kali smoking a cigarette. All this is done in the name of enlightenment and atheism.

Politics of the Ballot Box

In fact, everyone should follow their own religion, no one should make statements or actions that can hurt the feelings of others, and anyone who does should be legally opposed. However, looking at such a question in terms of political gain and loss, the definition of freedom of expression changes. Freedom of expression is available on large amount if the ballot box is strong, and freedom of expression is limited when the ballot box is negligible. If there is a strong ballot box, the emotions of a group are so sharp that they cannot even refer to their scriptures in discussions and arguments.

Overall, the politics of the ballot box and followers of the law of blasphemy is inviting chaos and challenges the very existence of democracy. Anti-national elements are succeeding in changing the meaning of democratic values like freedom of expression, secularism. This is an invisible enemy so it is impossible to fight this battle on the battlefield. We need a political leadership that prioritizes only democratic values by treating all religions equally, regardless of the profit and loss of the ballot box.

What Do Young Indians Want in Their Homes?

For real estate developers and their marketing teams today, things have changed a lot from 30 years ago. In India, first-time homebuyers are no longer people in their late 40s or early 50s who have saved up to fulfill their dream of buying a home. Today's first-time homebuyers are essentially millennials. In a relatively young country like India, they are now the most extensive customer segment for real estate developers.



By Akash Pharande
Managing Director - Pharande Spaces

What defines millennial homebuyers? Unlike the older generation who worked and saved all their life to finally fulfill their aspiration of homeownership, millennial homebuyers have six significant differentiators.

A Youthful Outlook

Above everything else, millennial homebuyers are young. This means that they come to the market with young people's aspirations. When they buy homes, they do not care so much about the things that mattered more to their parents, such as appreciation trends and returns on investment. Of course, they expect their homes to gain value over time (who doesn't?), but for ROI, they rely more on the stock market and often also on crypto currencies.

Instead, they want to own homes that help them explore their youthful zest for life experiences. Sure, proximity to the local kirana shop does matter - but so does having a lively cafe, a resto-bar that plays trendy music, and an overall youthful profile in the neighbourhood. Their interpretation of convenience also goes far beyond that of their parents. They are tech-savvy and expect to live in homes where technology plays a big role in the overall liv-



ability quotient.

Educated Research Vs. Educated Guesses

While their parents relied heavily on word-of-mouth recommendations from their family and friends, millennials instead put their superior education to good use. Many have degrees based on education far superior to the previous generation's. Back then, college degrees did not equip graduates to approach the homebuying process from a researcher's perspective.

Degrees in engineering, medical science, and even commerce are now heavily based on digital technologies. This is the age of the Internet and social media. The information highway is massive and very accessible to those who know how to traverse it. Millennials do.

Millennials do not buy homes based on flashy marketing, hype, and glib assurances. They do thorough homework, using their DigiTech skills to go beyond websites to extract information and feedback from consumer forums and social media platforms. Very few millennials arrive at a project site utterly clueless about the developer, his track record, the pros and cons of the project and location, and the average selling prices in the area.

In No Hurry To 'Settle Down'

This is something most developers still don't seem to understand - trying to market a project by appealing to a millennial's yearnings for a settled, married life is, more often than not, a fruitless undertaking. Millennials do not marry early in life, and quite a few don't have any such plans at all. The perception of relationships has changed tremendously in the last two to three decades.

Therefore, a hoarding that depicts how happy the project will make a young couple with kids may be missing the mark 70% of the time. That hoarding space should instead highlight how digitally efficient these homes are, how close the project is to trendy leisure and entertainment establishments, and how the in-house facility management will take excellent care of the house while the owners are travelling.

The Sustainability Imperative

When watching the latest outraged documentary about the plight of Planet Earth, we rarely see older people wielding the microphone. Almost without exception, today's environmental activists are young people - in some notable cases, barely out of school. Today's younger generations are keenly aware of how the previous ones allowed the environment to be exploited for short-term gains.

15-20 years ago, green homes were little more than a fad in India - a diverting indulgence for the idle rich, at best. Millennials are looped into what is happening on the planet, are personally concerned about it, and want energy-efficient homes in projects developed in an environmentally responsible manner.

They will prefer projects supported by solar energy, do not create needless heat islands, have sufficient greenery, and reduce the need for wasteful electrical appliances. They want to know where the wastewater goes and whether garbage is being segregated.

Size Matters - Flashiness Doesn't

Location still matters, but only from a price arbitrage angle. Millennials want larger homes than the centrally-located pigeon coops that satisfied their elders. They will happily forego vanity zip codes in favour of the more sedate suburbs if they can buy a flat that supports privacy, leisure, and working from home.

They are also less driven by other 'first impression' imperatives such as glitzy foyers and pseudo-spectacular architectural sweeps. The day's aesthetic is efficiency, defined by clean lines and the best possible use of space.

Unlike the earlier generations, millennials approach purchasing homes from the perspective of people who will not be spending the majority of their time there. Inspiring awe in those who visit them at home is not one of their priorities. They want to travel a lot and to socialize with their crowd in youthful, happening places when they're not traveling. Today's modern townships create such spaces within the townships themselves.

Health-centric Living

A residential project that doesn't offer a jogging track, tennis court, and gymnasium has already missed the millennial bus by a wide margin. Young people today aren't just concerned about their planet and each other - they are also heavily invested in their own wellbeing. Green open spaces aren't mere aesthetics to young homebuyers but represent lung space and prove that the developer hasn't sacrificed health and wellbeing on the altar of profit.

Considering all these defining aspects of India's millennial homebuyer demographic today, it is clear that a considerable number of older housing projects are of no interest to them. Millennials may rent homes in such projects, either because of budget constraints or because the locations around their workplaces do not have any projects that attract them.

But when they decide to ditch the rental hamster wheel and set out to buy homes, developers face a completely different breed of customers today than they did a couple of decades ago.

Draupadi Murmu will Enhance the Decorum of Presidentship

Lalit Garg



By declaring Draupadi Murmu as its candidate for the country's fifteenth presidential election, the Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance has raised the value of the tribal community, especially by bringing tribal life into the mainstream. This decision shows the political acumen and maturity of the BJP. She is a tribal daughter who will be the first tribal to reach the highest constitutional post and the second woman President of the Republic of India, which will give new strength to the democracy of India, along with the world. India is also changing rapidly. A new political vision, a new political environment is taking shape in the all-pervading turmoil, in this era, with Draupadi Murmu becoming the President, not only the dignity of this highest constitutional post will get a new record, but the national existence and identity will also be strengthened. Because her image has been that of a knowledgeable and soft-spoken politician of settled democratic traditions.

It is expected that her presence as the constitutional head of the country will reassure every Indian, especially tribal women, for their peaceful and safe life. Only the tribal can feel the pain of the tribal - that is, the pain of the reality that has been experienced. In my view, it is not surprising if Draupadi Murmu emerges as the biggest female heroine to raise the voice of the tribal and the oppressed in today's world. Former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee had sent a Muslim APJ Abdul Kalam to Rashtrapati Bhavan and now Narendra Modi first made a Dalit Ramnath Kovind the President and now Draupadi Murmu, a Scheduled Tribe, is being elevated to the highest post of the executive, which is certainly a healthy, ideal and aware democracy& as a sign of auspiciousness.

The credit for the presentation of Draupadi Murmu as a brilliant and historic presidential candidate goes to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and BJP President J.P. Nadda's strategy. Murmu's nomination is only sharpening the edge of lower class politics on which BJP has been working hard for a long time. The neglect of the tribal community across the country has been in the news since independence; Modi has been active since the beginning for the interest and welfare of the tribal's, affecting about 11 percent of the total electorate and about 25 percent of the total voter turnout.

Particularly, the BJP, comprising Narendra Modi, Amit Shah and J.P.Nadda, is giving special attention to the tribal community so that it can bring itself out of the limited identity of the urban party. When the names of presidential candidates were being discussed, I was hoping to get some names from the tribal community itself. Murmu was on top of them. Certainly, having a tribal woman in Rashtrapati Bhavan will enhance the image of BJP among the tribal community, whose direct impact can be seen in states like West Bengal,

Odisha, Jharkhand, Gujarat.

Narendra Modi has not only stunned and surprised the nation but has been doing miracles with his decisions; the same has been done by announcing the name of Draupadi Murmu. Because many targets have been hit with this one arrow. The BJP has been struggling hard in these states due to the presence of very powerful regional parties like Mamata Banerjee's Trinamool Congress in West Bengal, BJD in Odisha and Jharkhand Mukti Morcha in Jharkhand. Whereas in all these three states the dominance of Congress is negligible. In such a situation, by sending Draupadi Murmu to Rashtrapati Bhavan, BJP will not only be able to ease its fight, but will also be successful in making its place in these states. The elections in Gujrat are in front, there is also a tribal community in abundance, the effect of this decision will be seen there as well. On the other hand, for the Rashtriya Swayam Sevak Sangh, its fight against the conversion of a large number of tribal's on behalf of Christian missionaries may also become easier now.

BJP has been showing efficient and mature politics in these years. Their leadership, showing strategic acumen, made a tribal-Dalit-backward uprising over the years by making a person from a caste-backward background the Prime Minister, a person from a Dalit background as the President and now a tribal woman as the presidential candidate. The meaning has changed. It has been given the name of social harmony, after a tribal politician becomes the President, there will be justice for the tribal and backward class, it is believed. It is wrong to say that the President in India is only an office of symbolic importance.

Coming from a Dalit background, President K.R. Narayanan took a tough stand on the communal violence in Gujarat in 2002, forcing the then state government to change its stand on some matters, while President Giani Zail Singh, who came from a backward background, took many of the intoxicated Rajiv Gandhi government. The issues were sweated. Ramnath Kovind also strengthened the democracy of the country with his decisions taken from time to time. There is every possibility that Draupadi



Murmu will be elected as the President and after taking oath of this office, she will also display the same determination and make her tenure memorable for the country, which is free from terror, free from scams and free from communalism. In which Dalit, Adivasi and backward classes should get an equal and fair lifestyle of living.

Being a candidate from a simple family to the highest office of the country is a testimony to the glory of Indian democracy. Nothing can be better than being Draupadi Murmu's candidate as President and marching towards being elected is an inspiration to crores of people with similar backgrounds. This will not only give more strength to Indian democracy, but will also increase its fame. There is no doubt that Draupadi Murmu has been an ordinary politician, but India has a history that ordinary people have done 'extraordinary' things.

Draupadi Murmu was born on 20 June 1958 in Baidposi village of Mayurbhanj district of Odisha. His father's name is Biranchi Narayan Tudu. They belong to the tribal ethnic group, the Santhals. She graduated from Rama Devi Women's College. After this Draupadi started the job from the state secretariat of Odisha. She is married to Shyam Charan Murmu. In 1997, she became a local councilor for the first time by winning the election of Nagar Panchayat for the first time. Three years later, she got a chance to become an MLA from the same constituency of Rairangpur, first in 2000, and then twice as a minister in the BJP-BJD government. In 2015, she was made the first woman governor of Jharkhand. Former President V.V. Giri was also born in Odisha, but he was originally from Andhra Pradesh.

Murmu's life witnessed many crises and struggles, which shows her vitality. Apart from being a widow in her youth, she didn't feel any mental breakage even with the death of two sons. During this, she continued to encourage the entire family including her only daughter Itishree. Her eyes moistened when she was being administered oath as the Governor of Jharkhand. She is an ideal and courageous woman of religious rites. They have a special influence on Indian culture and rituals. Two days before the announcement of the name of her presidential candidate, she went to my son Gaurav Garg's in-laws' house in Rairangpur, and while feeding the cows, asked the operators there to pray for me. Perhaps she had some hope and possibility that her name might be announced. Gaumata heard the call of her heart.

Today, the fire of communal hatred is being deliberately fuelled in the country. All kinds of crises are being created, it is a great irony of democracy that heads are counted here,not brains. Our democracy is suffering because of this, it has been suffering. More heads are coming, not the brain. There are more masks of caste, religion and class, less faces of humanity. By deceitful use of intelligence, they create a maze of equations, from which Abhimanyu did not learn to get out. In fact, the people who drive democracy need such training so that a new definition of democracy can be rewritten.

This vision made Draupadi Murmu's role not only important but decisive as well. Therefore, by placing this burden on Draupadi Murmu, the country wants to be sure that the rule of the constitution is from Arunachal Pradesh to the President. It will run uninterrupted till Bengal and the country's borders will be completely safe because the President is the supreme commander of the armies. This will be the first time in the history of India that the dignity of the office will be increased by placing a powerful tribal woman as the President.



'Har Ghar Tiranga'

TAC News: Haryana is geared up to become the first State in the country to hoist tricolour at every house, Government, private, industrial and educational buildings. For three consecutive days every corner of the State of Haryana will be decorated with a tricolour to proudly remember the glorious history of India, under the 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign being celebrated countrywide from August 13 to August 15, 2022.

"Har Ghar Tiranga' is certainly a unique campaign, as it envisages Prime Minister, Sh. Narendra Modi's dream of invoking the feeling of patriotism among the citizens along with promoting awareness about the national flag. Therefore Haryana has to play a pivotal role in this campaign", said Sh. Manohar Lal.

While calling upon the NGOs and social organisations to ensure their active participation, Sh. Manohar Lal said that Har Ghar Tiranga holds special importance for every citizen, hence maximum participation is expected.

Adequate availability of tricolour should be ensured for the NGOs, citizens and other social organisations directed Sh. Manohar Lal.

CM further directed the officers concerned to launch extensive and aggressive IEC activities across the state for mass awareness.

"We have not got the freedom over the night, we have earned it after several supreme sacrifices. Therefore in this campaign, maximum participation should be ensured and the campaign should not be limited to the hoisting of tricolours at homes only, rather than every possible effort should be made to paste the tricolours on vehicles. This campaign should be celebrated as a national festival," said Manohar Lal.

Ensure maximum participation in this campaign with the 'Nation First, Always First' mantra'

Calling upon the people of the state, especially the Youth to enthusiastically participate in this campaign, Sh. Manohar Lal said that every Haryanvi has to move forward with the 'Nation First, Always First' mantra'.

He further said that this campaign will certainly prove a pivotal step in giving out a strong message to those who try to spread anti-national activities.

Let us participate in this national festival while rising above political idiologies

The Chief Minister said that every political leader should ensure thier participation in this national festival. While rising above the political ideologies every political party should participate in this campaign.

He directed the Deputy Commissioners to hold meetings with all political parties, public representatives, Zila Parishads etc. to ensure public participation in this campaign.

He said that during this entire campaign it is the utmost duty of everyone to respect the tricolour.

The Chief Minister further directed that a nodal team of various departments should also be constituted. Political institutions should also be involved in the house-to-house distribution of the Tricolour.

Create a buzz among the masses with marathon or rallies

The Chief Minister said that in a bid to create a buzz in the masses, various activities like marathon and cycle rallies should be planned a week ahead of the 'Har Ghar Tiranga campaign'.

He said no stone should be left unturned to ensure that this campaign should emerge as a 'Jan Andolan'.

"Every Deputy Commissioner should set a target of how many flags are needed in their respective districts, along with ensuring smooth house-to-house supply," said Sh. Manohar Lal.

Dedicated portal to be developed for this campaign

A portal will be developed and all the information related to this campaign will be uploaded on this portal. The government offices and NGOs will also upload their requirements about the flags. They can raise their concern about the availability of flags. House to house team should also be constituted for distribution and hoisting of flags at every home across Haryana.

Make this a National Festival

The Chief Minister said that the entire campaign should be celebrated as a national festival.

Every Vice Chancellor should ensure that before and during the celebration of this campaign a patriotic environment should be created on every university campus. Besides this, students should also be encouraged to actively participate.

The Department of Information Public Relations and Languages has planned a detailed programme of creating a buzz awareness by utilizing websites and social media handles of the state government. A plan has been made under which all state government websites to carry banners linking to the Amrit Mahotsava website - Har Ghar Trianga corner.



Ways To Save Money After Your Monthly Expenses

Rruchika Bhagat

"A penny saved is a penny earned" is a proverb frequently attributed to Benjamin Franklin. In other words, it's a good idea to save money, not waste it. So, in case you want to level up your financial life and you know that cutting expenses will only get you so far, start thinking about ways to add income.

Most of us have a lot of household expenses. One way to simplify your life and save money is to reduce your living expenses as much as possible. When you lower your monthly household expenses, you'll have more money to invest in your future or pay off debt.

While saving for the future can seem overwhelming, if you start by just putting away a little more money each month, it may be easier than you think. Saving money every month by carefully reviewing recurring monthly expenses, figuring out ways to trim those expenses and sticking to a budget is the secret to be on top of the ladder of financial deficit.

One of the smartest things you can do every month to save money is to comb through your monthly expenses and see where you can cut costs i.e., marking your wasteful expenses. On an average individual spend 38% to 40% of his earning on household expenses. Here are nine common monthly expenses and tips for saving money on each of them.

Housing

If you have a mortgage payment, consider saving money by refinancing your mortgage if interest rates are lower than what you're currently paying. This could give you a lower mortgage payment and save you a lot over the life of the loan. If you're a renter, you can compare loan instalment with rent paid per month, if both are same than better to buy a property on loan rather than paying rent. Similarly finding a roommate to split cost, signing a longer-term lease to score a discount or downsizing to a smaller, less expensive place are the other options to explore.

Utilities

Chances are that electricity represents the largest share of your monthly utility bill. So how can you reduce your electric bill? Start by unplugging unused appliances, adjusting your thermostat to settings that hog less power and turning off unused lights.

Food

To save money on groceries, try downloading apps that allow you to compare prices at different stores, buying in bulk at places like Costco and Sam's Club. This will not only reduce cost but you can also avail discount coupons and other gift vouchers.

Transportation

Getting from one place to other costs more than you might think including car parking and petrol refiling, Among the approaches you can take to drive down transportation expenses are:

- Buying electronic car rather than buying or leasing petrol/ diesel new car.
- Sticking to your car's recommended maintenance schedule to keep it running smoothly.
- Cutting back on speeding and hard braking to conserve gas.
- Carpooling or walking when possible.

Insurance

Paying insurance not only protect you from future contingencies but also give you tax advantage. While choosing insurance policy, one which secure the future with least insurance premium should be selected. You also can cut insurance expenses by exploring discounts, such as those for bundling policies from the same insurer.

Credit Card

Paying all expenses through credit card is the best way to plough back your finances into investments. We can claim the benefit of credit period and enjoy the fruits of our hard-earned money, provided all payments of credit card has to be done within due period to avoid any interest penalty.

Creating a budget

Creating a budget will help you lower your expenses because you can identify where you're spending too much money. A great first step to creating a budget is to make a spending plan. Use software such as Personal Capital, which will help you track and manage all of your accounts in one place. You can see your income, expenses, net worth, and more. You can also employ the cash envelope budget system if you want or need more control over your finances.

Invest in instruments with fixed returns

Warren Buffett once said, “The first rule of an investment is doesn’t lose money. And the second rule of an investment is don't forget the first rule.



We should not put all eggs in one basket. So, we should diversify our investment to mitigate risks. For example, invest some savings into bank fixed deposits, mutual funds, government pensions schemes and so on.

The idea is to invest regular amounts in these investment classes for a long period of time and generate good wealth. Diversifying is important because it keeps your portfolio away from being too heavily weighted towards one company or a sector. This helps in spreading the risk and ensuring your investments are sound and protected in the long run.

Evaluate your spending habits

Analyze your spending habits to understand if some costs are unnecessary and can be cut down like credit card bills. Avoiding these expenses can save a good amount which can be directed towards investments

Another easy way to analyze and improve your spending is also to prepare a detailed monthly budget. Junk food and entertainment are the most popular categories that fall under unnecessary expenses.

One can also segregate budget into wants and needs -- ‘needs’ includes necessary expenses like food, electricity, rent, internet and ‘wants’ include expenses that we do otherwise.

Automate your investments and be consistent

When it comes to investing, regular investments are more beneficial than a lump sum. In a regular investment, one has to invest a particular amount every month irrespective of the price of the asset.

Some investment products like mutual funds have options like systematic investment plans (SIP) with options to automate your investments. They deduct a fixed amount every month from the bank to invest in a fund. This process takes out emotions out of investing and avoids any delays in putting your money to work. It will also make you a disciplined investor. Before choosing investment, we need to take into consideration factors like time period involved, inflation rate, amount of investment and tax to be paid.

We should do expense planning and cash management; this will align our spending habits and will help us to reach our biggest money goals. It is rightly said, “Do not save what is left after spending, but spend what is left after saving.”

Grand Affair at Noida's Clinque

The party scene at Noida just got bigger with the opening of premium club Clinque, Garden Galleria. The Grand Launch was done by none other than Manya Pathak, who had Walked on the Cannes Red Carpet this year. Mr. Ayush Dwivedi is the Owner and Founder of Clinque. The party was well-attended by the city's food-lovers & party animals. Folks were seen grooving to the beats of the DJ and enjoying music, food & drinks. Page 3 Celebrities like Shalini Bhatia, Gunjan Sodhi, Shobha Giridhar, Preeti Jain, Anuj Lalwani and others attended the party.



Meenakshi & Shobha



Pooja, Trishla, Jayashree, Manya, Ruchi, Nisha



Victoria



Shalini & Isha



Anuj Lalwani



Dr. Charu



Gunjan

The India Designer Show Season 3 wrapped up with an exquisite range of collections





The action-packed season 3 of the India Designer Show was held in Delhi displaying extravagant collections of promising and young designers. The show was a big success portraying exciting luxury lifestyle designs in New Delhi.

Here, glamour was at its peak when many recognised celebs including Hina Khan, Kainat Arora, Stefy Patel, Shibani Kashyap, and Hitha ramped up the stage.

The India Designer Show 2022 was exclusively sponsored by prominent brands like Mens Craft,Metaspace, Tycoon Magazine, Juice Bucket, Archies, Prabhatam Group, Brand Monkey, our favourite radio station Red FM, Leaf Studio, BRICS Chamber and Bro Code. The dynamic advertising and productions too supported the show. The show was filmed by eminent photographer Gaurav and styling partner SanyaAnshula.

Delhi girl Shinata Chauhan-Femina Miss India 2nd Runners up-22 receives warm welcome



Delhi girl Shinata Chauhan, who was crowned as 2nd Runner Up, Femina Miss India 2022 received a warm welcome at Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi today. The beauty pageant finale was held in Mumbai at the Jio world centre recently.A group of as many as 50 people comprising members of Shinata's family, her brother Suryansh Chauhan and mother Kavita Chauhan , her relatives, friends, and neighbours swarmed the airport to receive the beauty queen. Shinata was garlanded by immediate family members and she also was showered with flower petals. On arriving in her hometown - Delhi, which she has done proud, Shinata Chauhan expressed gratitude to her parents and supporters for such a warm welcome. Shinata stated, “From the bottom of my heart, I want to thank all of you for giving me so much love and warm wishes. I also want to thank my parents for their immense support, who always stood by me at my good and bad times. Coming this far wouldn’t have been possible without their blessings and sheer effort.”

horoscope

20th July to 31st July

BY
Chhaya Singh



ARIES

This month you may be torn between wanting to do an excellent job and wanting to break free. Since you have an entire month to reconcile the two, you may be able to do so successfully.

July brings you the idea of 'choice'. Making the right choice will be difficult. There's something in you that wants to run away from just about everything. Hang in there. Intend for a real vacation, not for just a day off. Give yourself this treat, as you need it desperately.

TAURUS

July only means fun for you, and even though nobody gets an enjoyable month, you work simply for that purpose and work hard, too. It would be advised to pull back on the heavy spending, however, as you could end up in debt.

Don't worry too much about the future; your now moments are in good shape. You'll see improvements in your love life as well.

GEMINI

July brings you celebrations and renewals. This is the month when you think heavily about changing your life. You will see much success in the creative arts and be lauded for your work. You may run into a few communication-related issues as you won't be fully understood at the workplace.

Love is looking good for you this month, and it seems you'll finally get something (materialistic) you've always wanted.

CANCER

You'll be soaking up the Sun's last rays which will suit you just fine. This month goes to finishing up a project that will allow you to take time off.

Romance is definitely in your charts towards the end of the month you'll feel recharged and ready for a new project. Your creative juices are in excellent form, Cancer

LEO

There's much to rejoice about this month, Leo, as you'll be feeling powerful, and your personal charisma will make you feel like the most attractive person around.

It might feel as though all days lead to this day simply because the entire month is about working towards the goal, and the goal is completed on July 28. You will never be alone



during July 2022, and your companions will be loving, attentive, and compassionate.

VIRGO

July brings a test for you, Virgo, as patience will be required in heaping doses. The problem? Work. The rest is cake in comparison. Suppose you can keep your eye on the prize, which is time off and a solid plan for having fun and relaxation. In that case, you'll be able to keep your head while enduring your workplace environment.

Still, seriously, there's something wrong with your job, Virgo. You will have to stand up for yourself during this month. Do it. Don't buckle under pressure.

LIBRA

So much of your good, hard work will bear fruit in July, as you are one of the prime examples of how the transits can heal an aching heart. Your self-love wins out this month, which did not come easy to you. Alas, you have learned so many life lessons this year that you are ready to fend for yourself and stand tall.

While you are generally an impatient person, you will feel much more at ease with troublesome people as you recognize your ability to walk away when needed

SCORPIO

July has you holding your own but getting in a bit of trouble here and there because you aren't one to give in.

July brings you in abundance: self-respect. If you rely on yourself to get something important, then at least you know it will be completed.

SAGGITARIUS

You walk into July wearing the calm attitude. you'll be so healed and ready that you'll feel like a rocket of creative energy by mid-month.

This is a great month for you in terms of personal bests. You keep topping yourself as far as your creative endeavours go, and nothing makes you happier than being able to spend quality time on a project.

CAPRICON

You'll be ready to start something new in your life, and we're talking 'major upgrade.' You may not have had the nerve before. Still, this month will instil in you the confidence to leave an old situation behind so that you can freely walk into the future without baggage.

This may, unfortunately, mean that you'll be breaking up with someone, but it's not unfortunate if that person has caused you pain. Stand strong and be yourself. You're doing the right thing, Capricorn.

AQUARIUS

You are always open to healing, and you are one of those who actively pursue the betterment of your own mental-emotional state. You want to heal and grow, and during July of 2022, you'll be putting in great efforts to do both.

PISCES

You'll feel the drag, and you'll also feel the need to rebel from everything that feels like it's dragging. This month puts you on the fast track to clearing up your mind. If something doesn't make sense, you find out why or ditch it.

You have no time or patience for that which kills your progress. July exists as a hurdle for you to successfully jump over.

Rajkummar Rao, Sanya Malhotra and Director Sailesh Kolanu meets the Delhi Commissioner ahead of their release HIT: The First Case

As the HIT team reaches Delhi, they pave a special visit to the Commissioner, Rakesh Asthana inviting him for a special screening for Delhi Police hosted by Rajkummar Rao, Sanya Malhotra and Director, Dr Sailesh Kolanu.



Gulshan Kumar and T-Series present in association with Dil Raju Productions HIT: The First Case. Directed by Dr. Sailesh Kolanu, the film is produced by Bhushan Kumar, Dil Raju, Krishan Kumar, and Kuldeep Rathore. The film starring Rajkummar Rao and Sanya Malhotra hits the theatres on the 15th of July, 2022.

Vidyut Jaamwal & Shivaleeka Oberoi Spotted in Delhi For their Upcoming Movie Khuda Haafiz chapter 2 Promotion

New Age Action Hero Vidyut Jammwal and Actress Shivaleeka Oberoi came to delhi for their sequal movie Khuda Haafiz Chapter 2. The film is scheduled to be released theatrically on 8 July 2022. Khuda Haafiz Chapter 2 is an Action thriller and emotional movie written by Faruk Kabir and produced by kumar Mangat Pathak. It is a second movie of Vidyut and Shivaleeka together as Khuda Haafiz Part first is based on True incident story, and second part is comneting sequal Vidyut said " he came know that story is not ended there so he came up with second part". He also added that story is about a common man that when it's come to his child till where he can go or what he can do to save his child. Shivaleeka also shared that playing Nargis character is very emotional and physically challenging and Every women can relate to the character of Nargis. The promotion end by saying they were very happy and excited that khuda Haafiz Chapter 2 is releasing in threaters.

"Naar ka Sur" Gives the message of Women Empowerment



Naar ka sur is all set to release on 5 August 2022. The movie gives a strong message of Women Empowerment. The film is co produced by Step by Step hospitality Ltd and Maya Movies along with producer Sunil Tayal. The movie is directed by Kuldeep Kaushik The story of the movie will revolve around 12 women who struggle to get justice in the country. Each story will have a strong message that women can overcome any challenge that comes their way.The 12 women who will ve playing lead in the movie have been chosen from the different parts of the country. Despite of this, the trailer of the movie got trended on twitter as soon it was released.

Shubham Mathur Productions' Red Notice Netflix trailers with Shikhar Dhavan and Kareena Kapoor have become a hit with film fans



The action-adventure film "Red Notice," starring Dwayne Johnson, Ryan Reynolds, and Gal Gadot, is eagerly anticipated by the film buffs in India after watching its Netflix trailers with Indian cricketer Shikhar Dhawan and Bollywood Diva Kareena Kapoor.

Shubham Mathur Productions, founded by an ace casting director and producer Shubham Mathur, has become a name to be reckoned with in Bollywood. Mathur is the person who turned Big Boss season 15's Pratik Sahejpal, Shivam Sharma, and Aahana Sharma into stars, who are now showcasing their acting abilities on various television shows, music videos, and web series.

"It is the creativity that makes every actor a brand name," Shubham Mathur said. They're like fireworks, and I'm the one who sets them off and gets them on the right platform," said Shubham.

Shubham casted the majority of the eye-catching television commercials, including projects such as Hyundai with Shah Rukh Khan, One8 Deo with Viraat Kohli, MTV Splitsvilla , MTV Roadies and many more.

Also produced many ads like Van Heusen with Jacqueline Fernandez, and others. He has also created advertisements featuring famous Indian cricketers such as Suresh Raina, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, and Yuzvendra Chahal, as well as a television commercial for the Delhi Government.

He is known for his creativity and innovations and currently casting for a popular show for MTV and Zee TV; and he has previously worked on shows for Amazon Prime, Netflix, Mx Player, MTV, and others.

Govt taking strict steps to stop illegal mining

Haryana Government has taken stringent steps from time to time to check illegal mining in the state. The government has constituted a District Level Task Force (DLTF) under the Chairmanship of the concerned Deputy Commissioner. This Task Force conducts surprise inspections of the affected areas and is fully equipped to take strong action at the ground level. A spokesperson of the Haryana Government said that illegal mining does not only mean illegal mining of mined material but also includes illegal transportation of mined material by vehicles. Due to this, such vehicles carrying illegal mining material are confiscated by the Mines, Geology Department as well as the police. The spokesperson said that the Mining Department has recently received 18 police personnel (1 Inspector, 4 Sub Inspector, 4 Head Constable and 9 Constable) on deputation from the Police Department, who have been deployed to check illegal mining. 60 more police personnel will join in the near future.



According to the spokesperson, 138 FIRs have been registered for illegal mining in the year 2022-23. Along with this, a fine of about Rs. 1,31,29,158 has been recovered by confiscating 253 vehicles. In the year 2022-23 in Nuh, 68 vehicles involved in illegal mining have been seized and 23 FIRs have been registered. A fine of Rs. 4,28,400 has been recovered from illegal miners in Nuh. The spokesperson said that it has been decided to use satellite imagery for regular monitoring of mining in the state. Along with this, in future all vehicles carrying mining material from mining contract area of any mineral will be equipped with GPS.

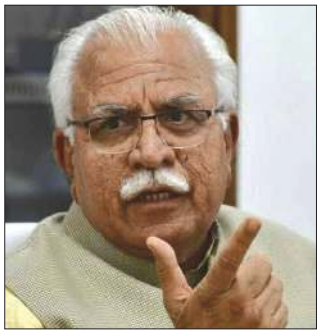
The spokesperson further said that strict directions have been issued by the government to the Deputy Commissioners and the Superintendents of Police regarding illegal mining. DCs have been directed to ensure that regular meetings of the District Level Task Force are convened to review the action taken on illegal mining. At the same time, illegal mining should be investigated and sensitive areas prone to illegal mining should be identified and special teams of officers should regularly inspect the sensitive areas.

Cheerag Scheme: Qualitative education for all

Haryana government-led by Manohar Lal is committed to provide qualitative education to all the children in the state. Haryana Government is laying emphasis on providing education of poor students along with equal opportunity to the students of classes II to XII to study in recognized private schools from the on-going academic session. For this purpose, a progressive scheme "Chief Minister Equal Education Relief, Assistance and Grant (Cheerag)" has been started by the state government.

Cheerag Scheme, a boon for the children of poor families

Haryana Chief Minister, Manohar Lal said that in the year 2022-23, a budget of more than Rs. 20,000 crore has been earmarked for education sector. For this, the State Government is starting various new schemes and programmes to provide equal education to all children. Cheerag Scheme is also one of the schemes started for the children of poor parents across the state. Under this scheme, the children studying in government schools having parents' annual verified income of less than Rs. 1.80 lakh can take admission in private schools from class II to XII with the consent of private schools.



The Chief Minister said that under the Cheerag scheme, Rs. 700 per student from classes II to V, Rs 900 per student from classes VI to VIII and Rs 1100 per student from classes IX to XII, per month or the declared fee amount in Form 6, whichever is less will be paid to the schools. He said that under this scheme, 381 private recognized schools of the state are going to give admission to the students on 24,987 seats.

CM Manohar Lal said that while successfully implementing Section 12(1) (c) in the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 in the state, a separate provision has been made to provide free education to children of weaker section studying in Class I or previous classes on 25 percent seats in all recognized private schools.

Manohar Lal said that from Classes I to XII, no fee is charged in all government schools of the state. It is worth mentioning that from Classes I to VIII, uniforms, text-books, work books, stationery, school bags and lunch are being provided free of cost. In English medium, Bag-free Model Sanskriti Schools, there is a provision of free education for students having parents' annual verified income of less than Rs. 1.80 lakh. Nominal monthly contribution is taken from the children of families having annual income above Rs. 1.80 lakh in the state.

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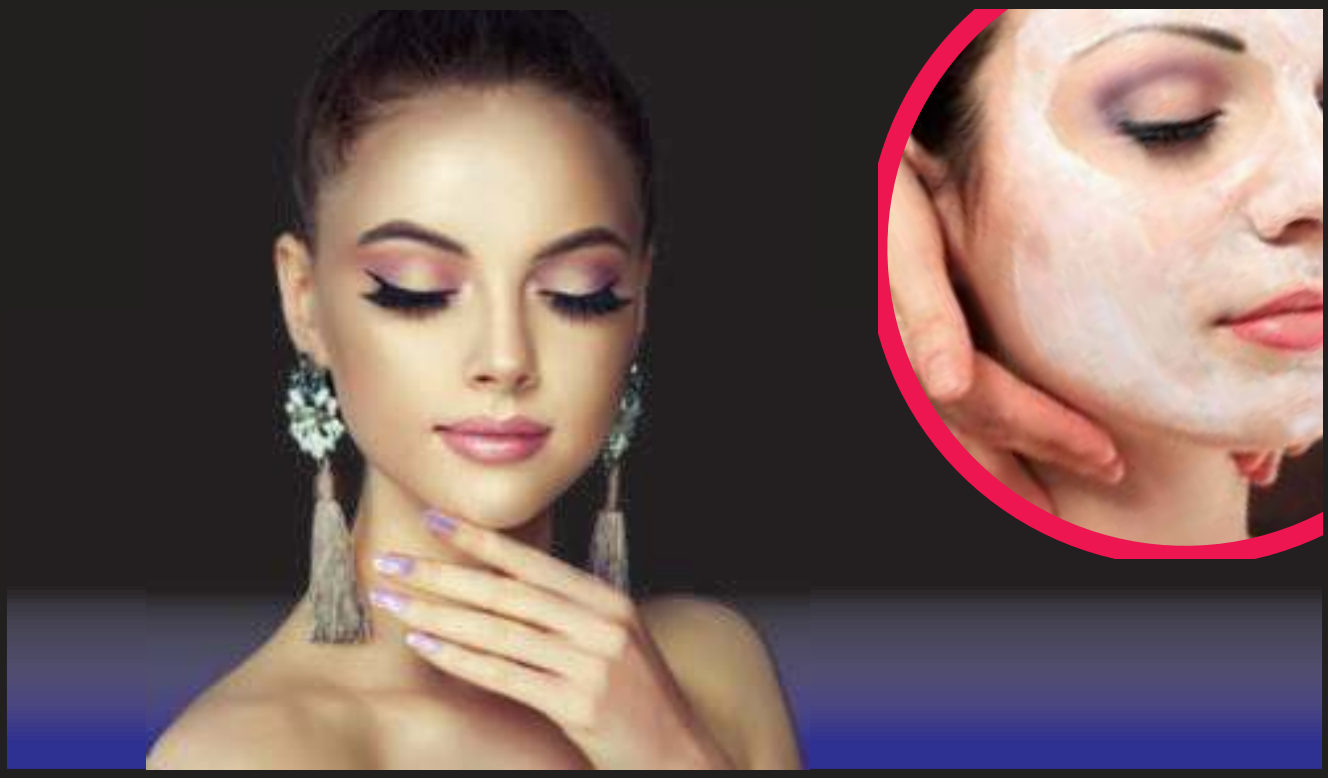
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